

INDIA — LOCATION, EXTENT + BOUNDARIES

Size • Hemisphere • Standard Time • Neighbours • Coastline

World share → Extent & latitude/longitude → Tropic of Cancer & IST → Land borders → Coastal boundary

- Headings & Definitions ● Explanations ● Highlighter = Key Facts 🎯 Exam Tip ✗ Common Mistake
🧠 Memory Trick

StudyPlanner



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INDIA'S PLACE IN THE WORLD

- India occupies about 2.4% of the world's total area
- India is home to about 17.7% of the world's population
- India is the 7th largest country in the world by area
- Australia is the 6th largest country in the world by area



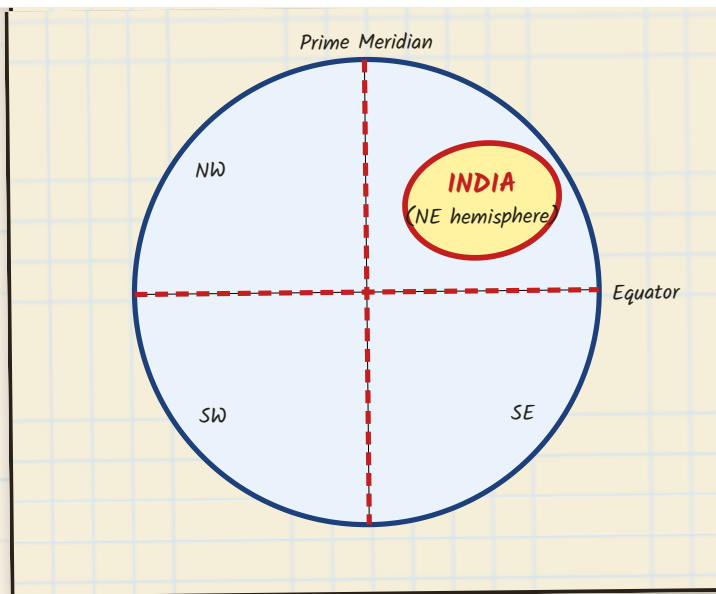
Location — Hemisphere

The **Equator** divides the Earth into the Northern and Southern Hemispheres, while the **Prime Meridian** divides it into the Eastern and Western Hemispheres. India lies entirely in the North-Eastern Hemisphere — north of the Equator and east of the Prime Meridian.



Fig 1: India's Position — Hemispheres





India's Extent

Measurement	Value
North-South extension	3,214 km
East-West extension	2,933 km
Latitudinal extent	8°4' N to 37°6' N
Longitudinal extent	68° E to 97° E



Memory Trick

North-South (3214) is **bigger** than East-West (2933) — India is "taller" than it is "wide." Just remember $3214 > 2933$.

Territorial Waters

India's maritime/territorial limit extends up to **12 nautical miles** into the sea — roughly equal to **22 km**.



Exam Tip

Latitude range (8°–37°) spans about 29°, and longitude range (68°–97°) spans about 29° too — both are used directly to calculate India's Standard Time on the next page!

THE TROPIC OF CANCER + INDIAN STANDARD TIME

Tropic of Cancer ($23\frac{1}{2}^{\circ}$ N)

The Tropic of Cancer passes right through the middle of India, crossing through

8 states, from west to east:



Memory Trick

"Gujarati Raja became Chief Justice in the meeting" → Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura, Mizoram.



Exam Tip

Of these 8 states, only **3** have their capital above the Tropic of Cancer: **Rajasthan (Jaipur)**, **Tripura (Agartala)**, and **Mizoram (Aizawl)**. The rest — Gandhinagar, Bhopal, Raipur, Ranchi, Kolkata — lie below it.

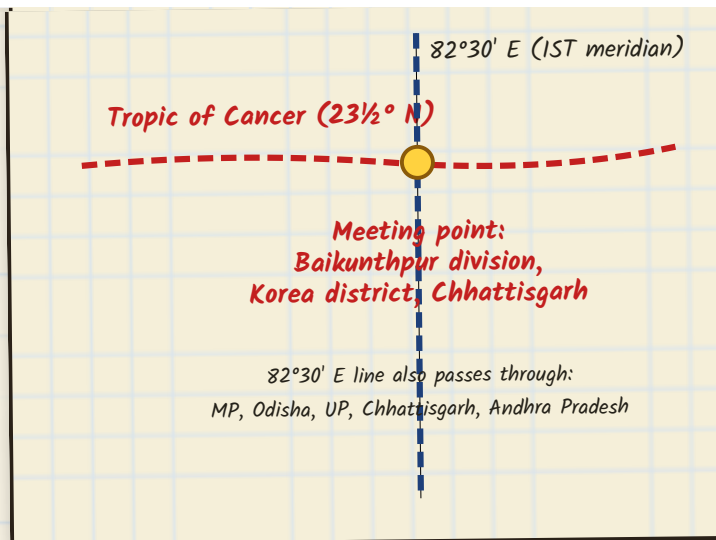
Indian Standard Time (IST)

India's longitude spans roughly 30° (68° E to 97° E) — and 30° of longitude equals about a **2-hour** time difference. To avoid using two separate time zones, India adopted a single standard meridian at **$82^{\circ}30'$ E**, right in the middle.

Indian Standard Time is **$5\frac{1}{2}$ hours ahead of GMT** (Greenwich Mean Time / Prime Meridian).



Fig 2: Tropic of Cancer $\times$ $82^{\circ}30'$ E — Where They Meet



- The 82°30' E meridian passes through 5 states: Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, Uttar Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Andhra Pradesh (memory trick: "Mauka")
- It meets the Tropic of Cancer in Chhattisgarh, in the Korea district's Baikunthpur division

✗ Common Mistake

Not every country has just one time zone — countries with a large longitudinal spread have many. France has 13 time zones and the US has 6, mainly because of their vast east-west (longitudinal) spread, including overseas territories.

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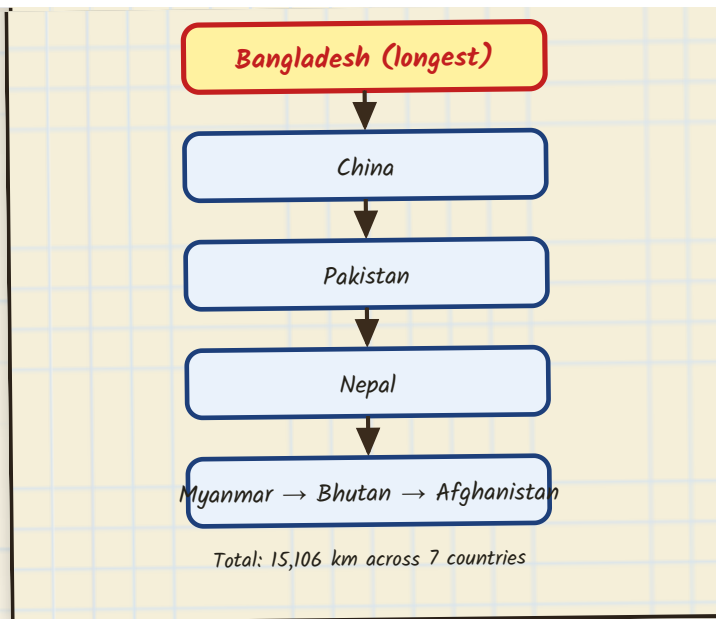
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INDIA'S INTERNATIONAL LAND BOUNDARIES

India shares a land border with 7 countries, totalling 15,106 km. The list is remembered in decreasing order of border length — Bangladesh has the longest shared border, and Afghanistan the shortest.

Fig 3: India's 7 Land Neighbours (longest → shortest)



Memory Trick

Childhood mnemonic: remember **B**angladesh, **C**hina, **P**akistan, **N**epal, **M**yanmar, **B**hutan, **A**fghanistan — 7 countries, already in decreasing order of border length.

Uttar Pradesh's Record

Uttar Pradesh shares its boundary with the most states/UTs of any Indian state — **9 states and 1 Union Territory (Delhi)**.



Named International Boundary Lines

Line	Between
Radcliffe Line	India-Pakistan & India-Bangladesh
McMahon Line	India-China boundary (divided into Western, Middle & Eastern sectors)
49th Parallel	USA-Canada (longest international boundary in the world)
Maginot Line	France-Germany
Hindenburg Line	Belgium-France
Durand Line	India/Pakistan-Afghanistan



Memory Trick

The **Radcliffe Line** was drawn by **Sir Cyril Radcliffe** after Partition — it separates India from both Pakistan and Bangladesh, since Bangladesh was originally **East Pakistan** before becoming independent in **1971**.

✗ Common Mistake

Don't mix up the **49th Parallel** (world's longest international boundary, USA–Canada) with the **McMahon Line** (India–China) — very different boundaries with very different records!

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NORTHEAST + HIMALAYAN NEIGHBOURS

States Bordering Bangladesh

Meghalaya, Assam, Mizoram, Tripura, West Bengal — remembered with the trick phrase "Ma'am take water."

States Bordering Myanmar (North → South)

Arunachal Pradesh → Nagaland → Manipur → Mizoram



Memory Trick

"Arunaamami" — Aruna(chal), Naga(land), Mani(pur), Mi(zoram), read top to bottom on the map.

States Bordering Nepal

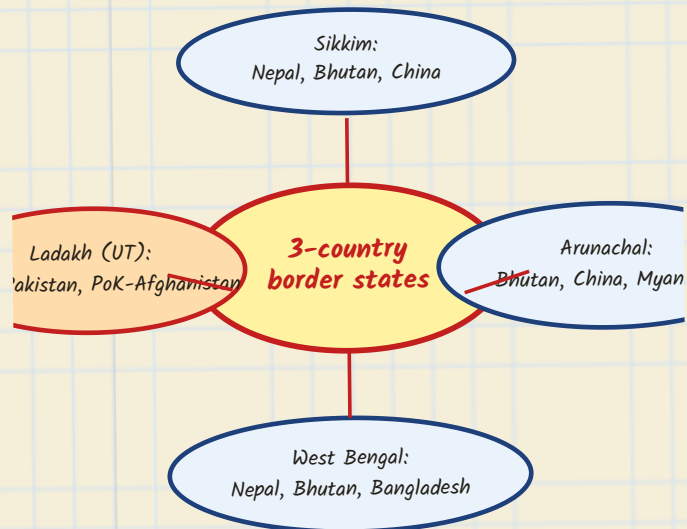
Sikkim, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, [West] Bengal, Uttarakhand — remembered as "Subu Subu" (S-U-B-B-U).

States Bordering Bhutan

[West] Bengal, Assam, Sikkim, Arunachal [Pradesh] — remembered as "Basa" (B-A-S-A).



Fig 4: States Sharing Borders with 3 Countries



Exam Tip

Three **states** border exactly 3 countries: **Sikkim** (Nepal, Bhutan, China), **Arunachal Pradesh** (Bhutan, China, Myanmar), and **West Bengal** (Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh) — plus the **UT of Ladakh** (China, Pakistan, and the PoK region bordering Afghanistan).

States Bordering Pakistan

Gujarat, Rajasthan, Punjab, Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh.



Common Mistake

Don't forget **Ladakh** when listing states/UTs bordering Pakistan — it's often left out since it's a Union Territory, not a state, but it does share a Pakistan border.



INDIA'S COASTAL BOUNDARY

India's coastline length was recently revised by the Government of India, published around late April / early May 2025.

Measure	Value
Old coastline length	7,516 km
Revised coastline length (2025)	11,098 km

✗ Common Mistake

If you learned the old figure of 7,516 km for India's coastline, update it — the Government of India published a **revised, more precise figure of 11,098 km** in 2025. Don't answer with the outdated number if the question specifies "as per latest data."

Top Coastlines

- Andaman & Nicobar Islands has the longest coastline overall (including UTs) — both before and after the revision
- Among states, **Gujarat** has the longest coastline (approx. 2,300 km) — both before and after the revision
- Order among states: Gujarat → Tamil Nadu → Andhra Pradesh
- Goa has the shortest coastline among coastal states

 Fig 5: Coastline Length — Quick Comparison

Andaman & Nicobar — longest overall (UT)

Gujarat ≈ 2,300 km (longest state)

Tamil Nadu

Andhra Pradesh

Goa — shortest

Coastal States & Union Territories

India has 9 coastal states and 4 coastal Union Territories. Among the UTs:

- Andaman & Nicobar Islands
- Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu
- Puducherry — itself spread across enclaves in three different states: the main Puducherry region and Karaikal (in Tamil Nadu), Mahe (in Kerala), and Yanam (in Andhra Pradesh)

 Puducherry isn't one single block on the map — it's four separate enclaves (Puducherry, Karaikal, Mahe, Yanam) sitting inside three different states!

Exam Tip

Always double-check whether a coastline question is asking for the **old (7,516 km)** or **revised (11,098 km)** figure — recently revised data is a favourite trap in current-affairs-linked geography questions.

★ Exam-Ready Summary

- **Area/Population share:** 2.4% area, 17.7% population, 7th largest country
- **Extent:** N-S 3,214 km, E-W 2,933 km; 8°4'–37°6' N, 68°–97° E
- **Standard meridian:** 82°30' E → IST = GMT + 5:30
- **Land neighbours:** 7 countries, 15,106 km total
- **Coastline:** 11,098 km (revised 2025); Gujarat longest state, Goa shortest, Andaman & Nicobar longest overall

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 Print Notes